UWB WEBINAR SERIES

RESTRICTED

SESSION 2:
Introducing Ultra-Wideband (UWB) Radar

CAS HAMBURG
JULY 2022

SECURE CONNECTIONS FOR A SMARTER WORLD



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CONTENT OVERVIEW

- Radar
- UWB Radar Pulse
- IEEE Frame Format
- UWB Radar Receiver Concept
- Signal Processing
- Q&A

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Radar

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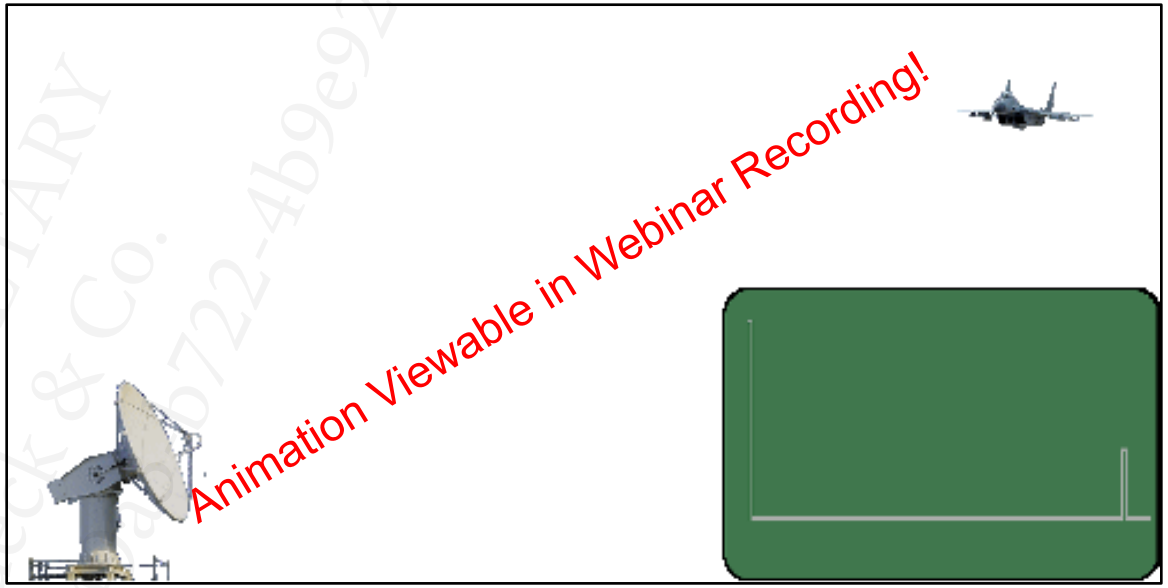
SIMPLE PULSED RADAR

- RADAR (radio detection and ranging)
- Time between Radar and Target:

  ΔT = Round trip time
- Speed of the transmitted signal:

  c = Speed of light
- Range between Radar and Target:

$$R = \frac{c * \Delta T}{2}$$



Animation source: https://www.radartutorial.eu/

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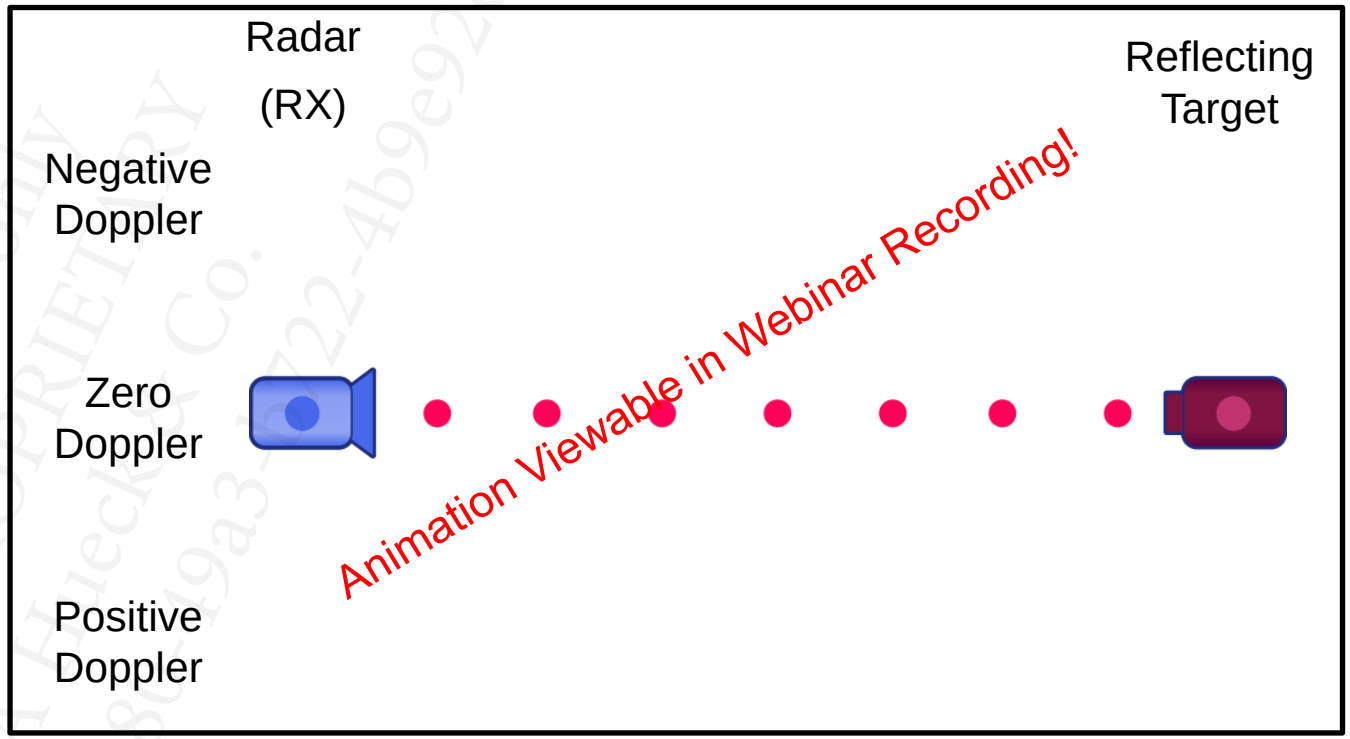
PULSED DOPPLER RADAR

- Transmitting multiple pulses enables the doppler effect, allowing to resolve the velocity of a target
- Frequency of signal transmission:

  f_t = Transmission frequency
- Difference between transmission frequency and shifted frequency due to a moving target:

  $f_D = f_{shift} - f_t$ = Doppler frequency
- Velocity of target relative to the Radar:

  $v = \frac{c * f_D}{2 f_t}$



Animation source: https://www.einstein-online.info/

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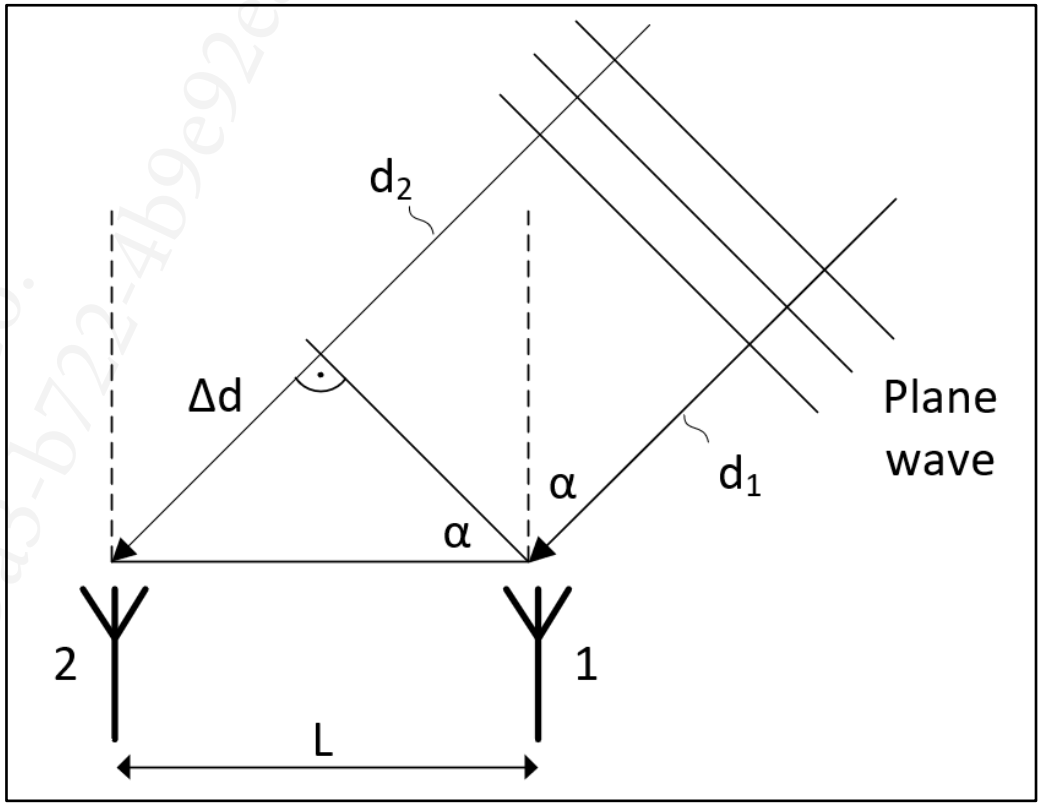
MULTI-CHANNEL RADAR

- Receiving from multiple antennas located in space allows to resolve the Angle of Arrival (AoA) of a target due to the increased path distance between the Radar antennas and the target
- The length between the center of the two antennas:

  L = Distance between the antennas
- Additional distance to get to the second antenna

  $\Delta d = c * \Delta\tau$ = speed of light * additional trip time
- The Angle of Arrival of the target relative to the Radar at boresight

  $\alpha = \arcsin(\frac{c*\Delta\tau}{L})$



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UWB Radar Pulse



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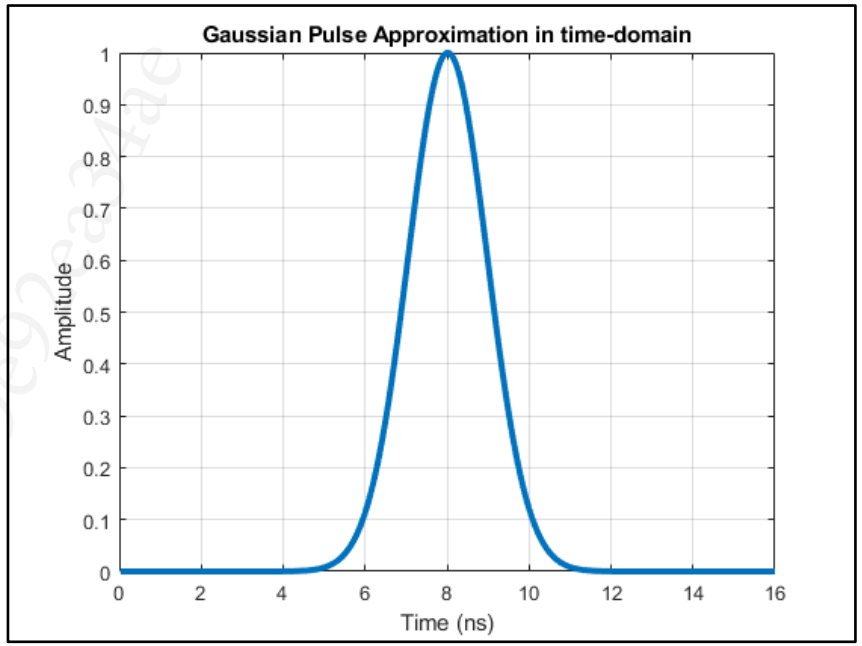
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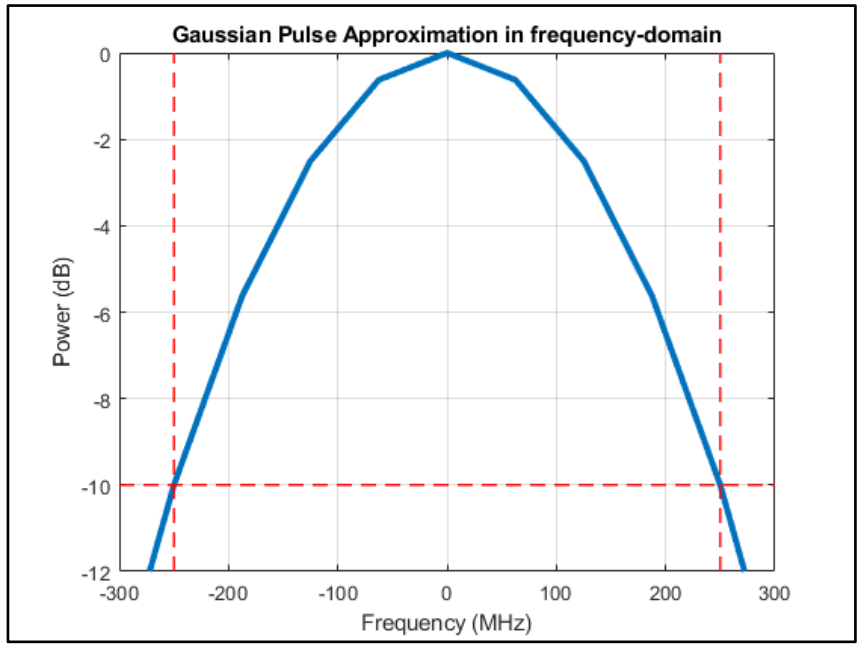
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UWB RADAR PULSE SHAPE

- Optimal Pulse Shape that estimates a Gaussian Window
- No post- or pre-ringing -> reduces artefacts in measurements
- Remains compliant with IEEE reference pulse
- Bandwidth of the UWB Radar Pulse:

  B= ~ 500 MHz

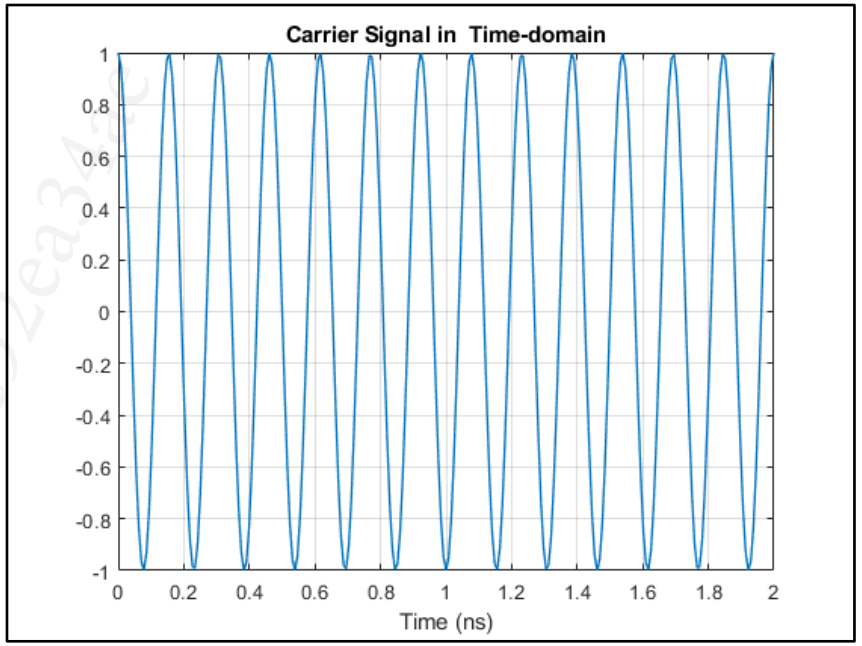


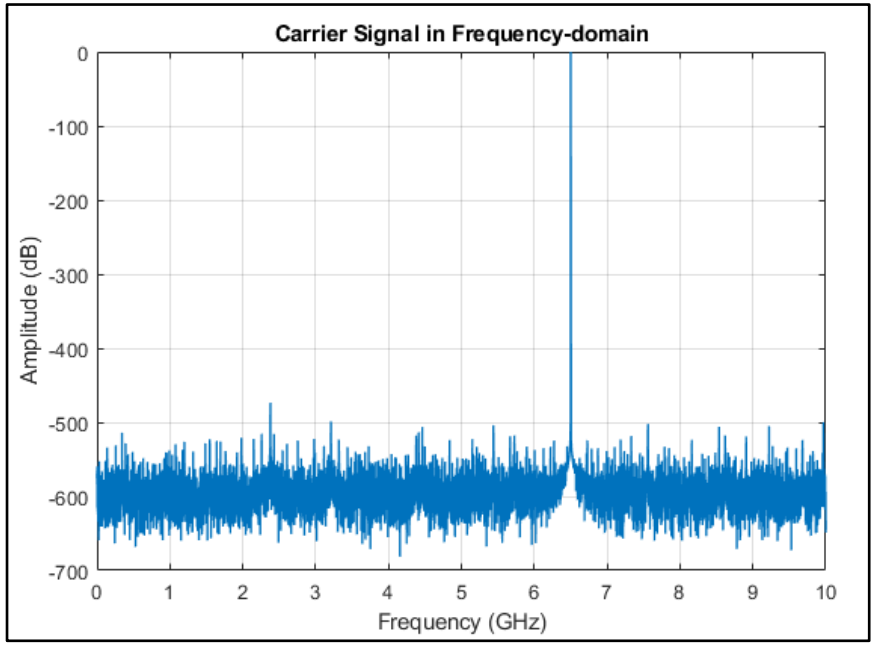


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CARRIER SIGNAL

- Carrier frequency defines the channel:
  - 5: 6489.6 MHz
  - 6: 6988.8 MHz
  - 8: 7488.0 MHz
  - 9: 7987.2 MHz
- Is a simple cosine wave with a constant frequency

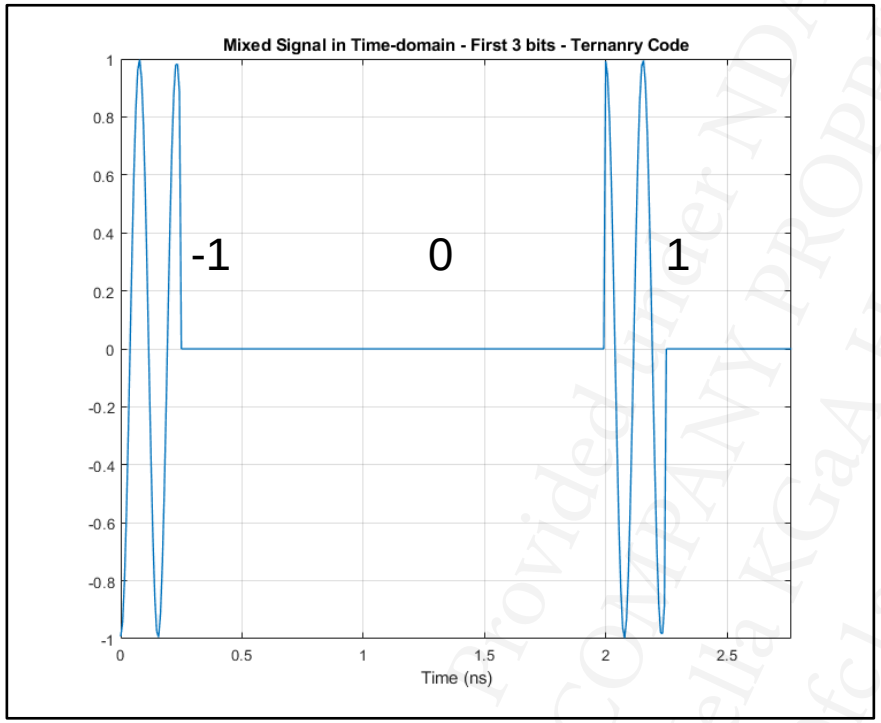




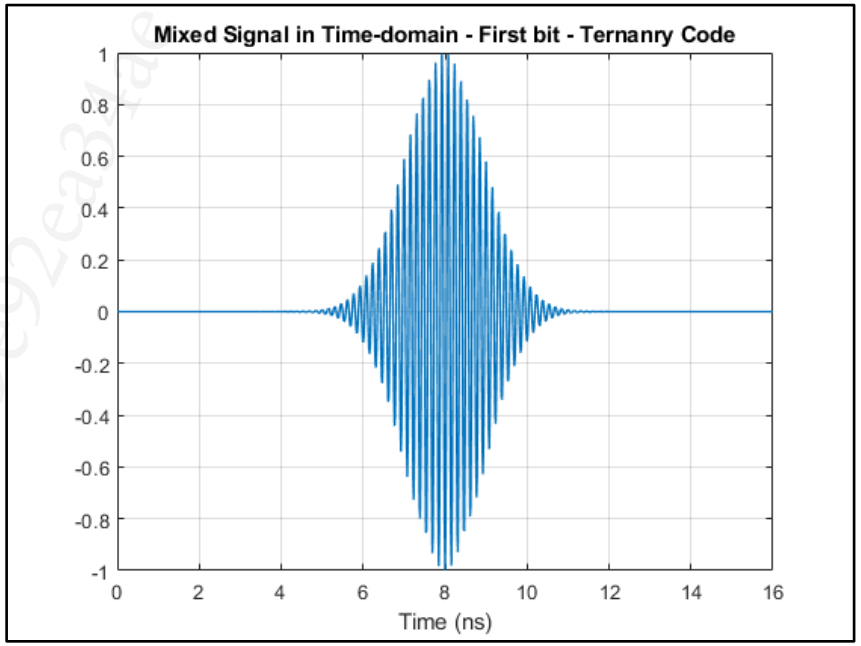
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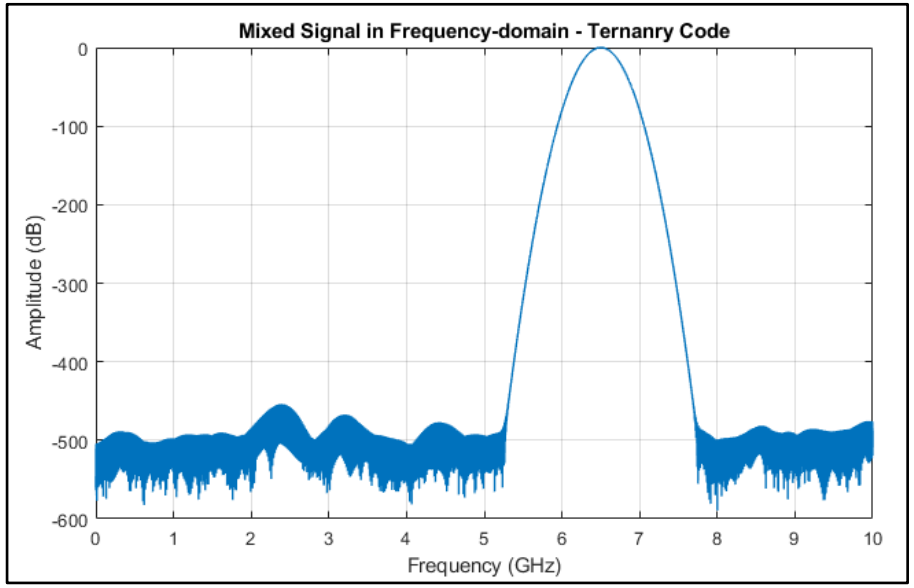
MIXED SIGNAL

- Mixing the carrier signal with the pulse modulates the signal to a higher frequency and allows transmission through space
- Radar pulse shape achieves near zero side-lobes contrary to a Ranging pulse



*Not actual mixed signal, shown for illustration of modulation only





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IEEE Frame Format



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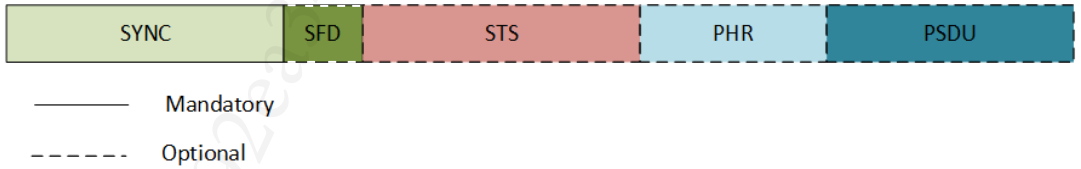
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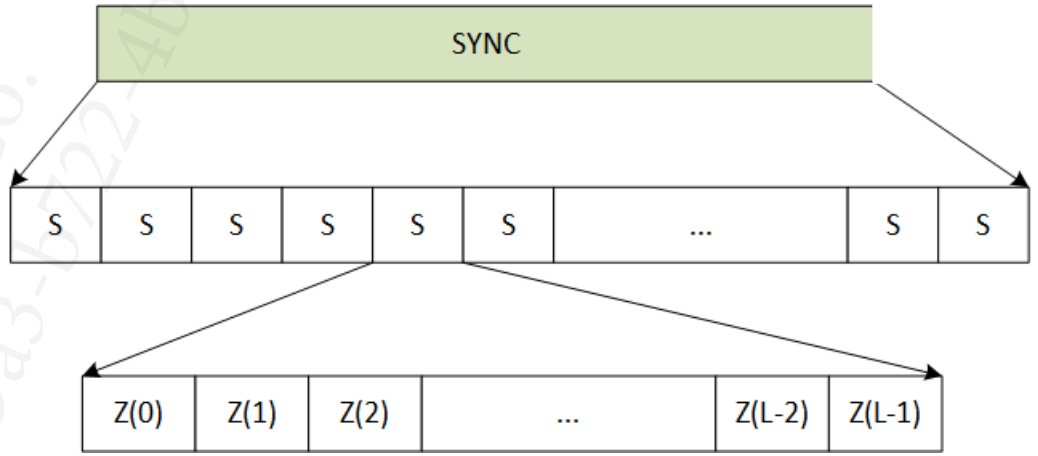
UWB RADAR FRAME

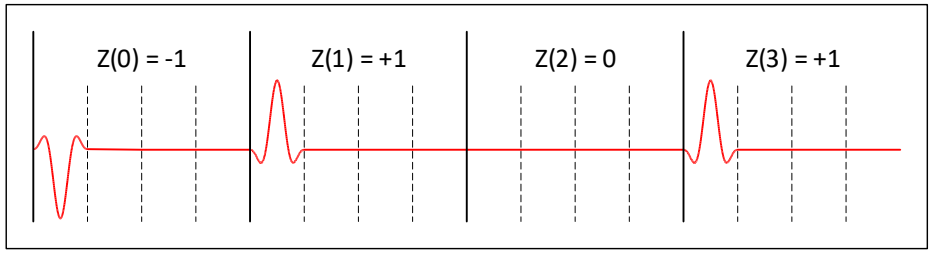
- Frames optimized for UWB Radar operation
  - No SFD, STS and no Payload
- SYNC:
  - 124.8 MHz PRF
- Pulses can be coded as +1, 0, -1 (Ternary Code)
- Or can be coded as +1, -1 (Binary Code)

IEEE Standard UWB frame format



Radar Frame



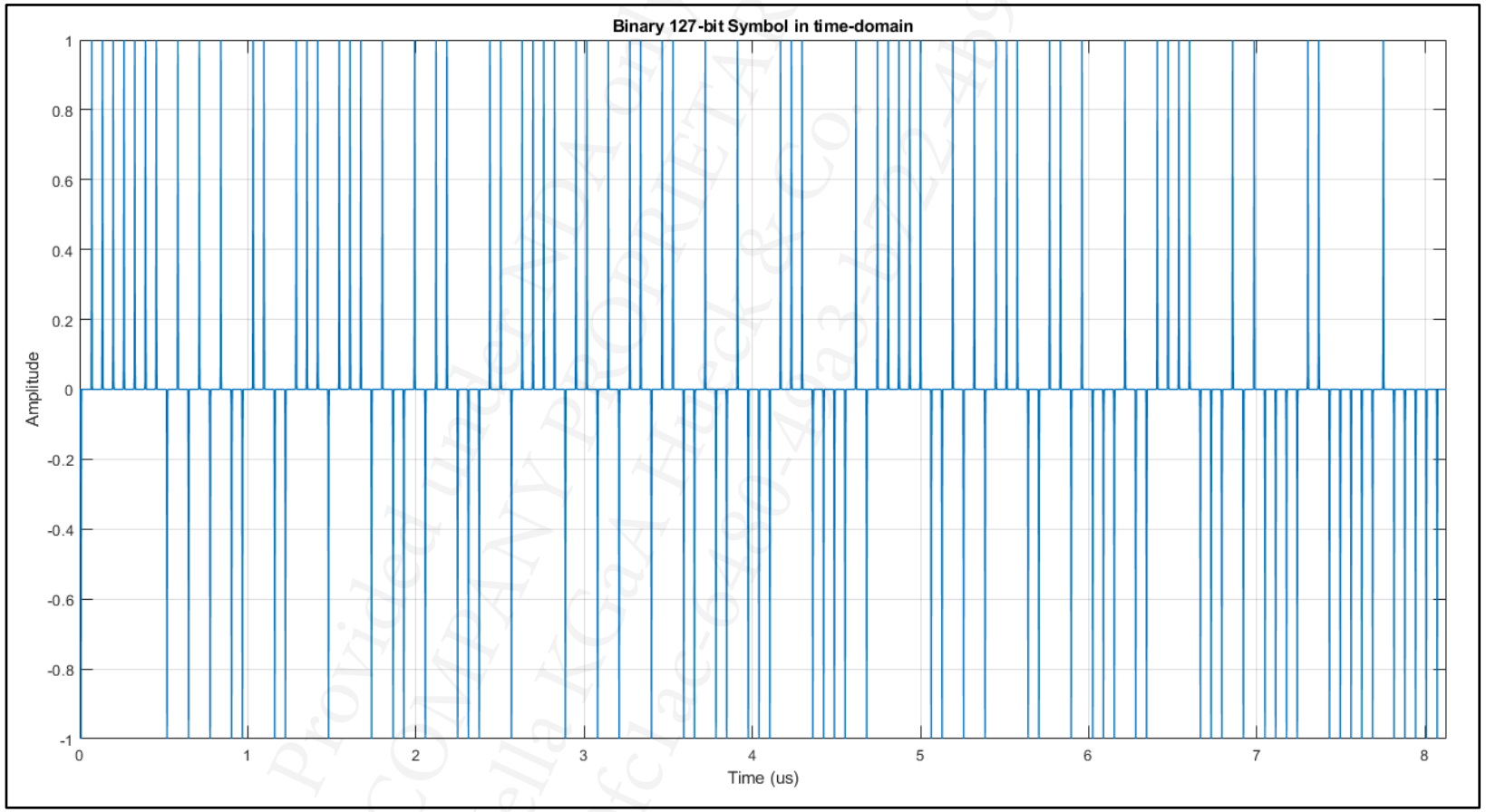


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BINARY SYMBOL

- Exemplary Binary code with 127 bits:

[-+++++++-+-+-+--++--+++-+++-+--+-++---++-++++-++-+-++-++--+--+---+++----+-++++--+-+-
+++--++-+---+--++++---+-+----++-----+-----]

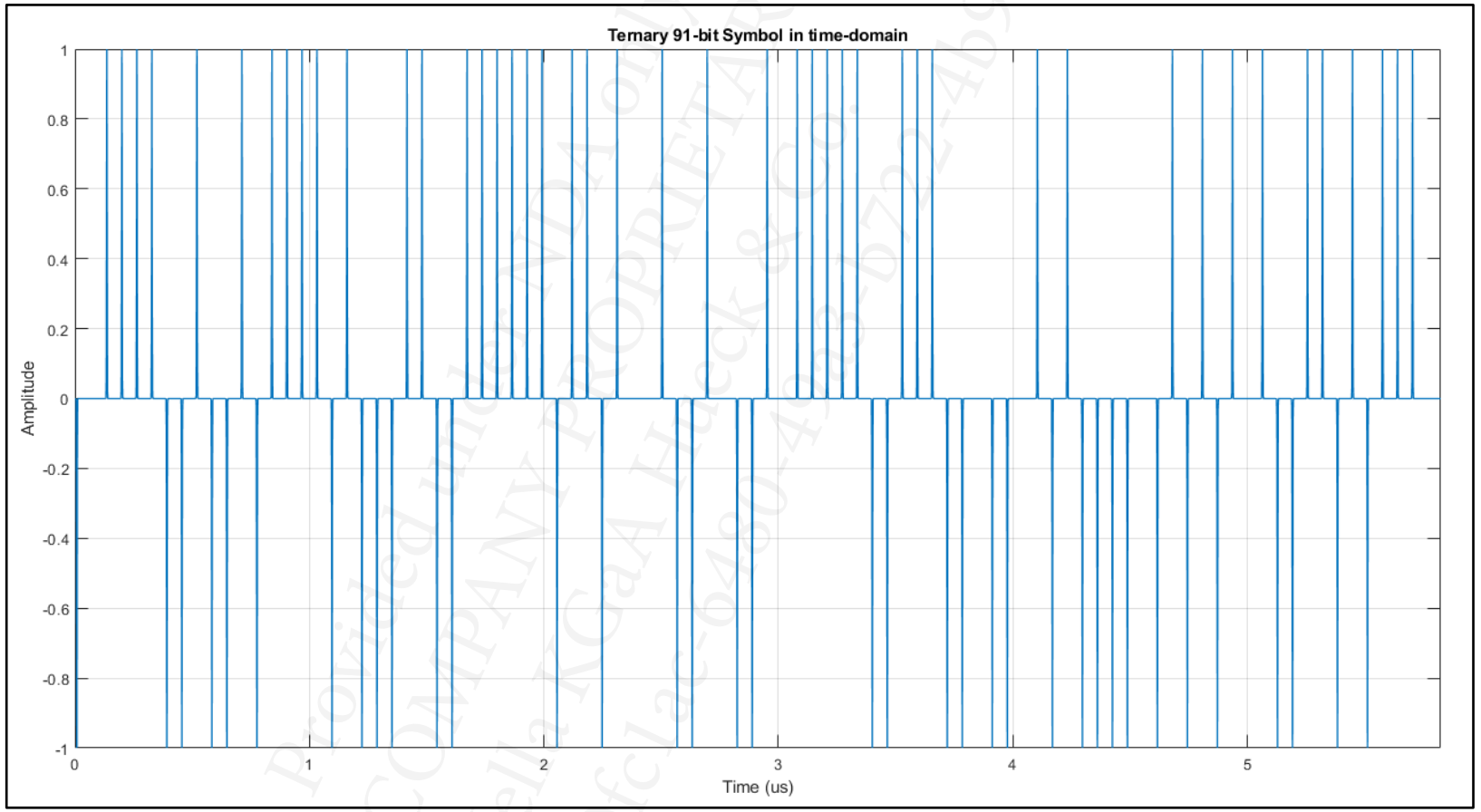


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TERNARY SYMBOL

- Exemplary Ternary Code with 91 bits:

[-0++++--+--+-++++-+---++--+++++++-++-+00+--+0--+0+++++--+++--0--0+-+----0-+-+-+0+--++-+-+++0]



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UWB Radar Receiver Concept

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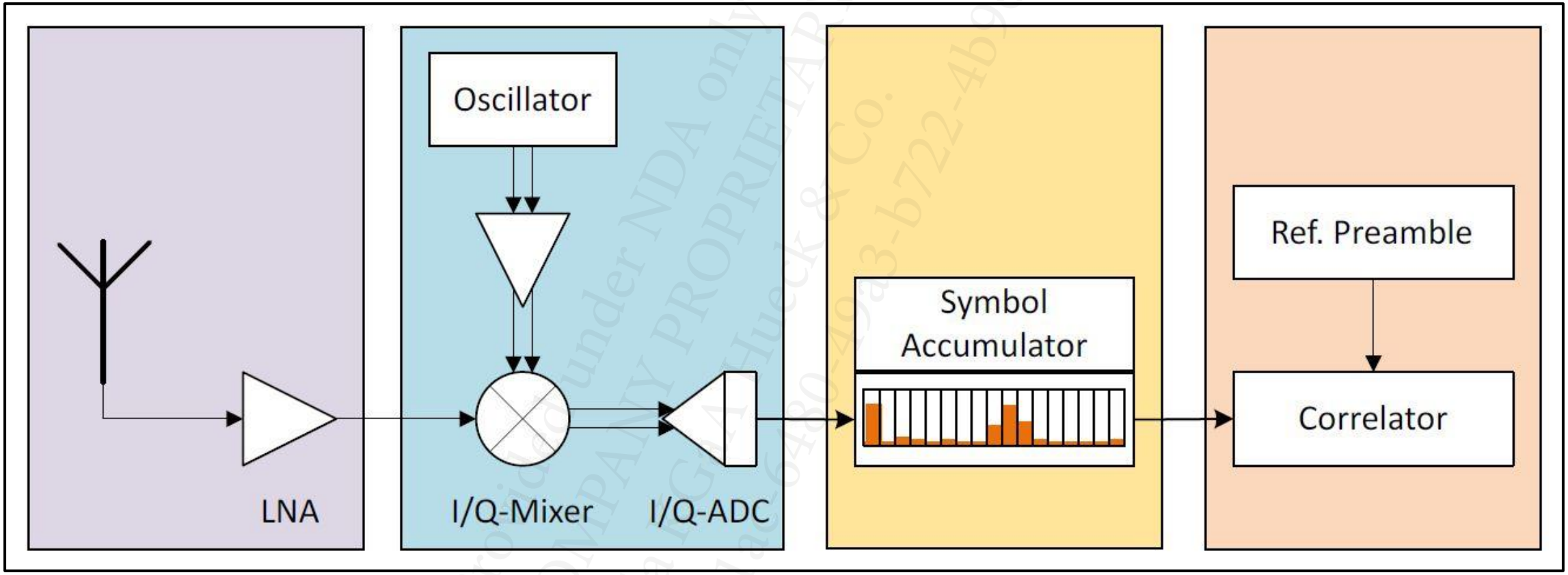
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UWB RADAR RECEIVER

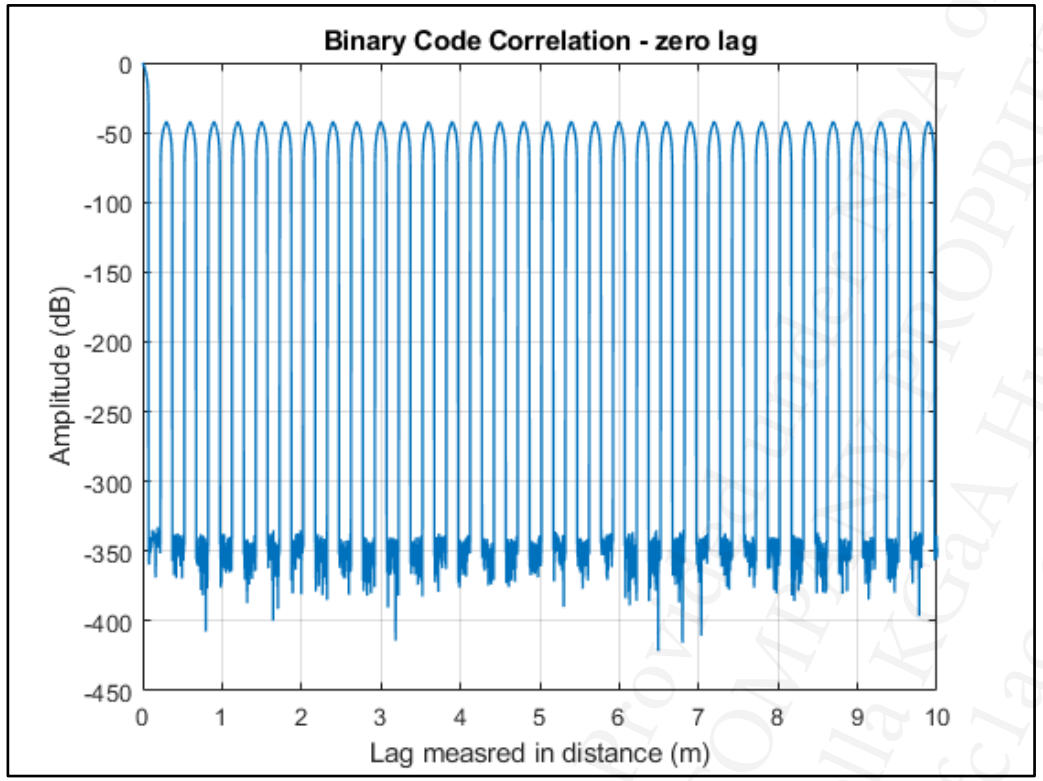
- UWB Radar receiver accumulates then correlates
- Software implementation of the correlator with higher quantization increases SNR

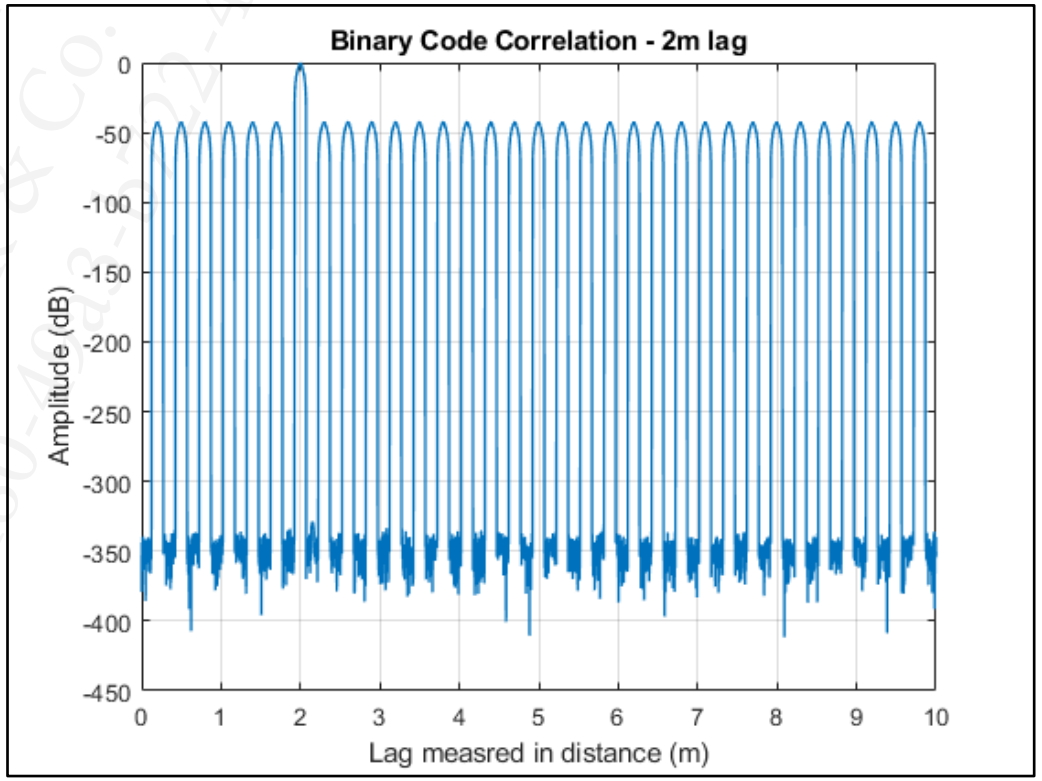


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CHANNEL IMPULSE RESPONSE – BINARY CODE

- Binary codes suffer from correlation artefacts that significantly increases the noise floor
- Targets need to be much-more reflective to be observed above the artefact level near ~ -50 dB
- A target at a given distance is a lag in the correlator input signal, hence shifting the correlation peak
- The influence of the pulse shape can be seen clearly here

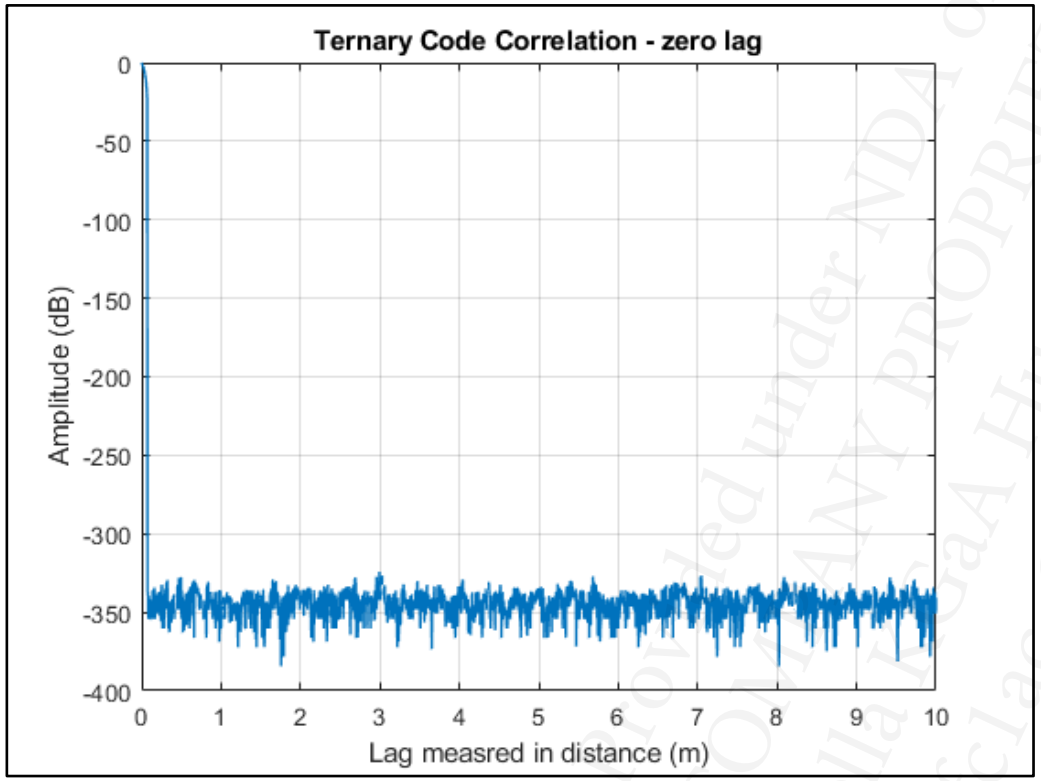


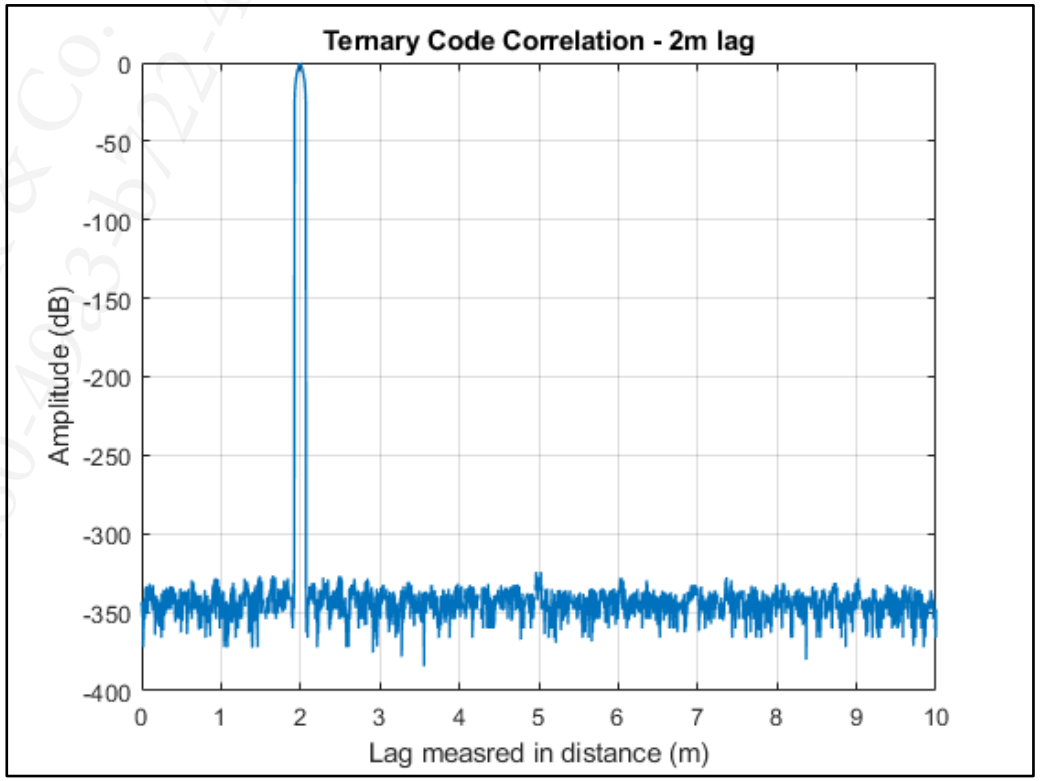


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CHANNEL IMPULSE RESPONSE – TERNARY CODE

- Ternary Codes achieves near perfect correlation
- Allows for a much-reduced noise floor, hence detection of less reflective targets is possible

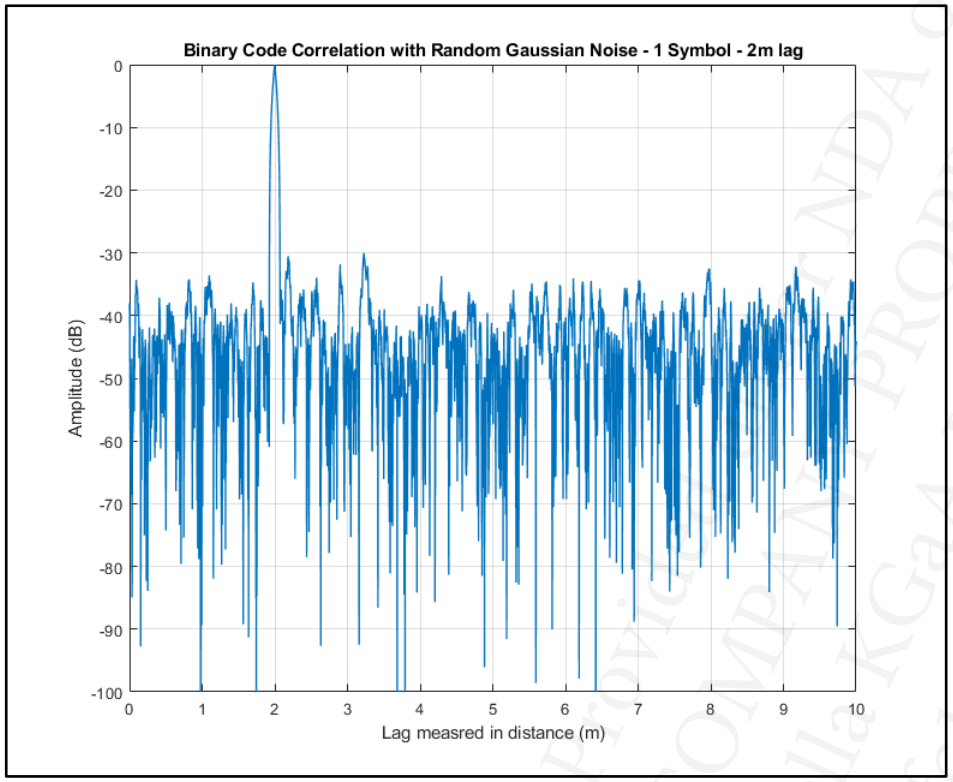


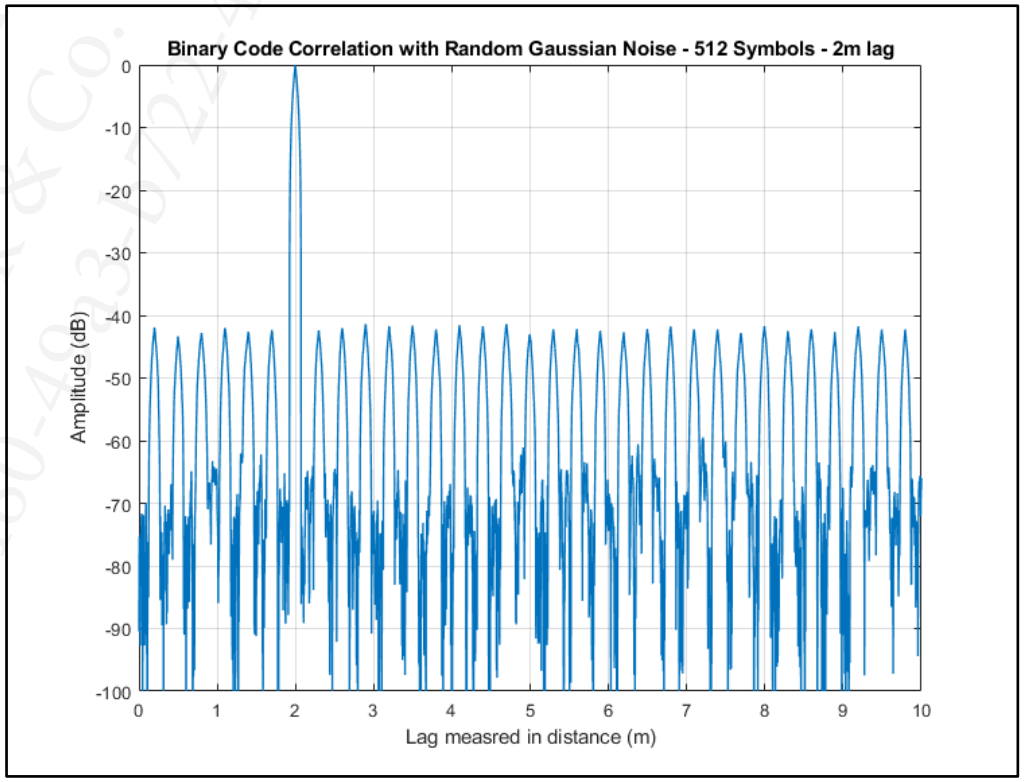


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ACCUMULATOR EFFECT - BINARY

- Accumulation (coherent integration) over 512 symbols increases SNR by about ~ 10 dB
- Binary Codes correlation artefact remains

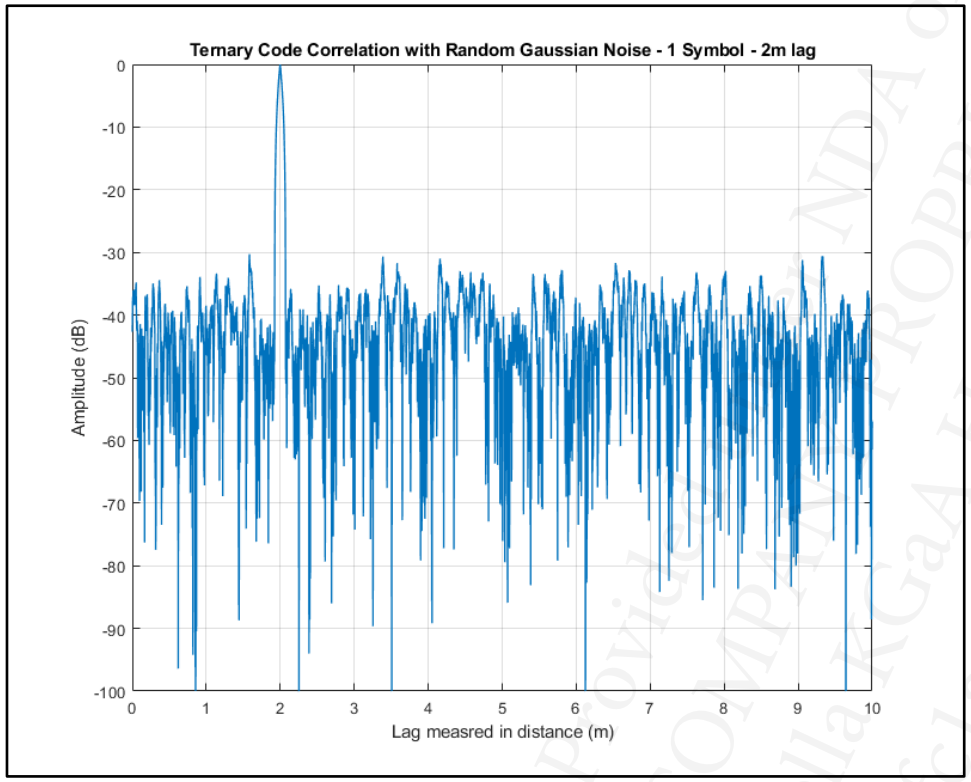


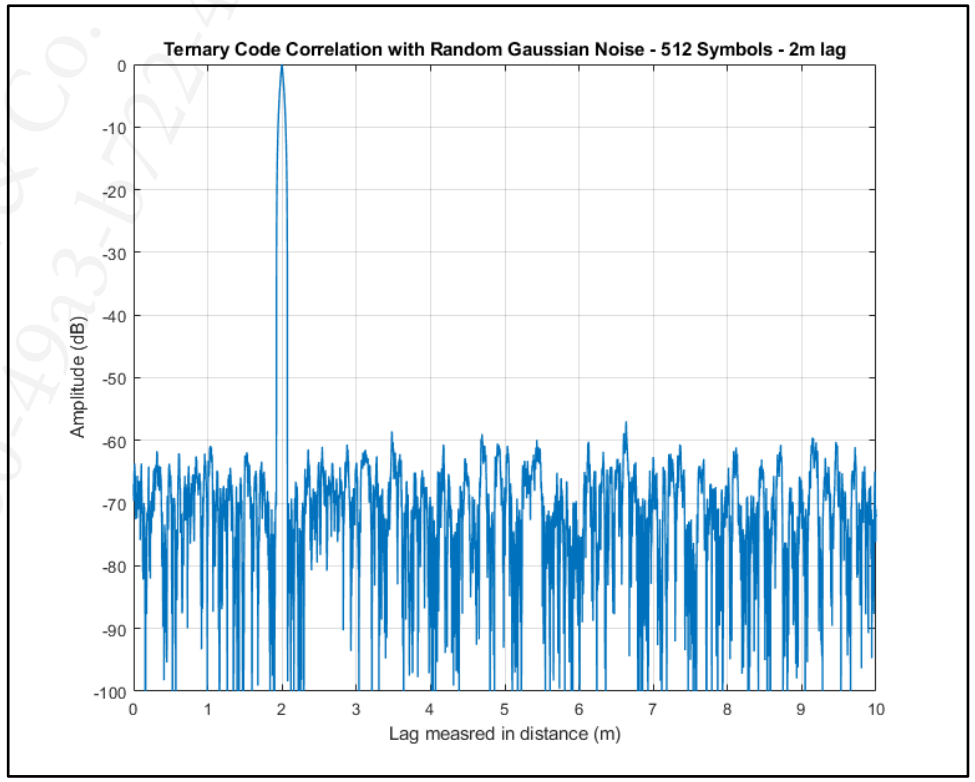


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ACCUMULATOR EFFECT – TERNARY

- Accumulation (coherent integration) of 512 symbols increases SNR by roughly ~ 10+20 dB
- No correlation artefact is present with ternary codes (~ 20 dB)





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Signal Processing



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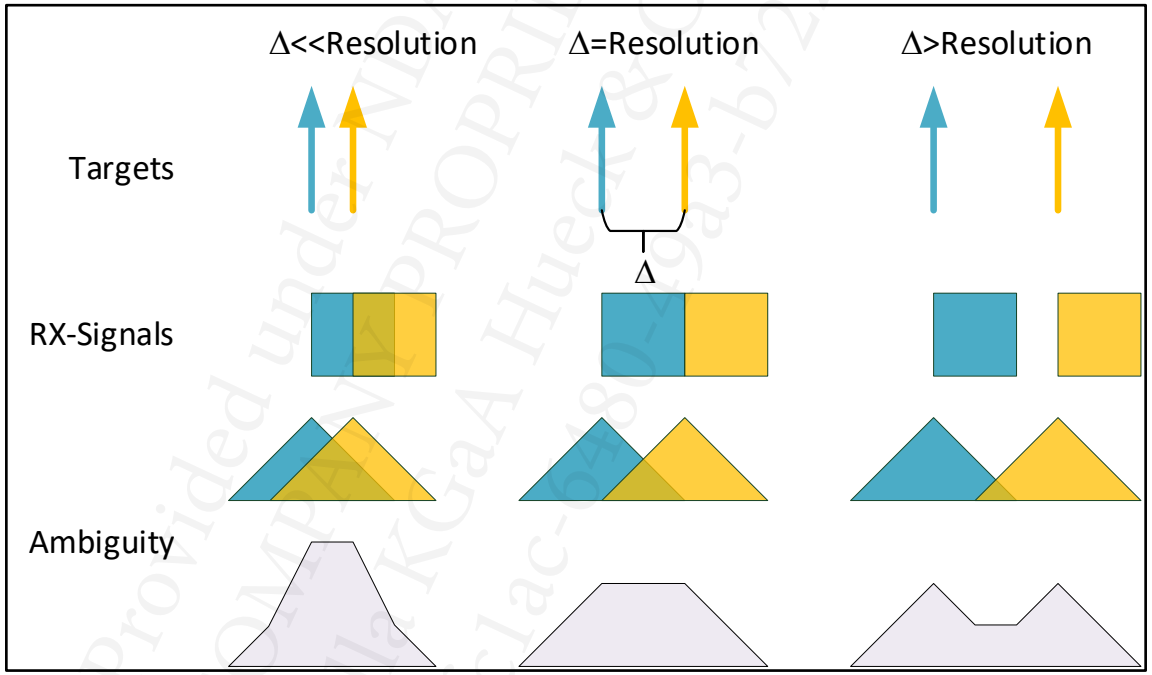
RANGE

- Maximum Range is related to the Symbol Repetition Frequency:

  $R_{max} = \frac{c}{2*SRF}$ -> well over 100 meters for 512 symbols for both binary and ternary codes

- Range resolution is related to the bandwidth of the transmitted pulse:

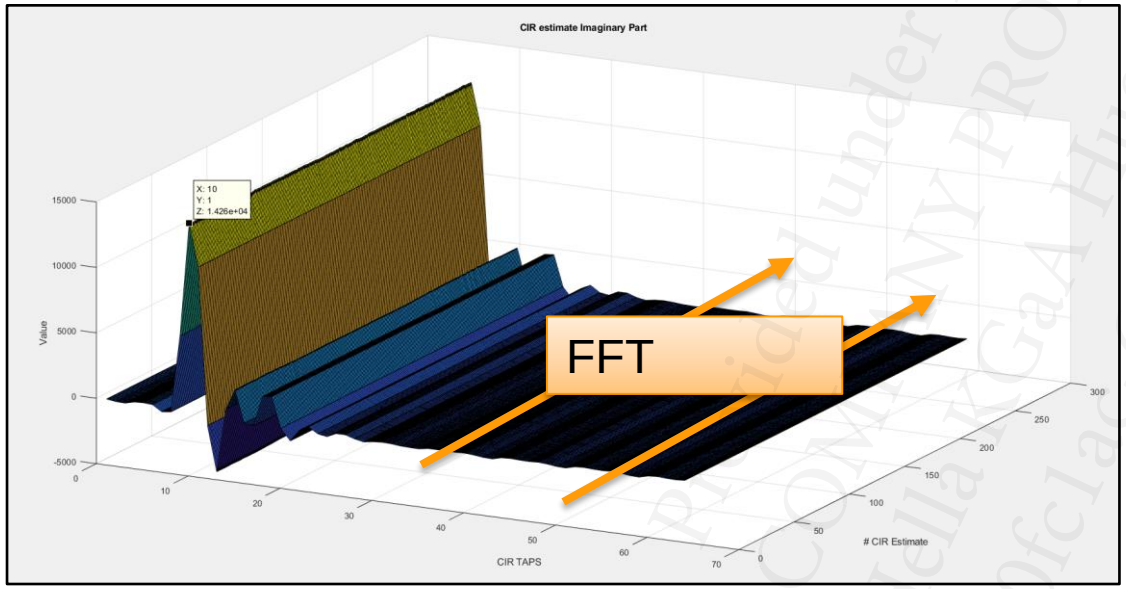
  $R_{res} = \frac{c}{2*B}$ = ~ 30 cm -> can be reduced by detecting the leading edge

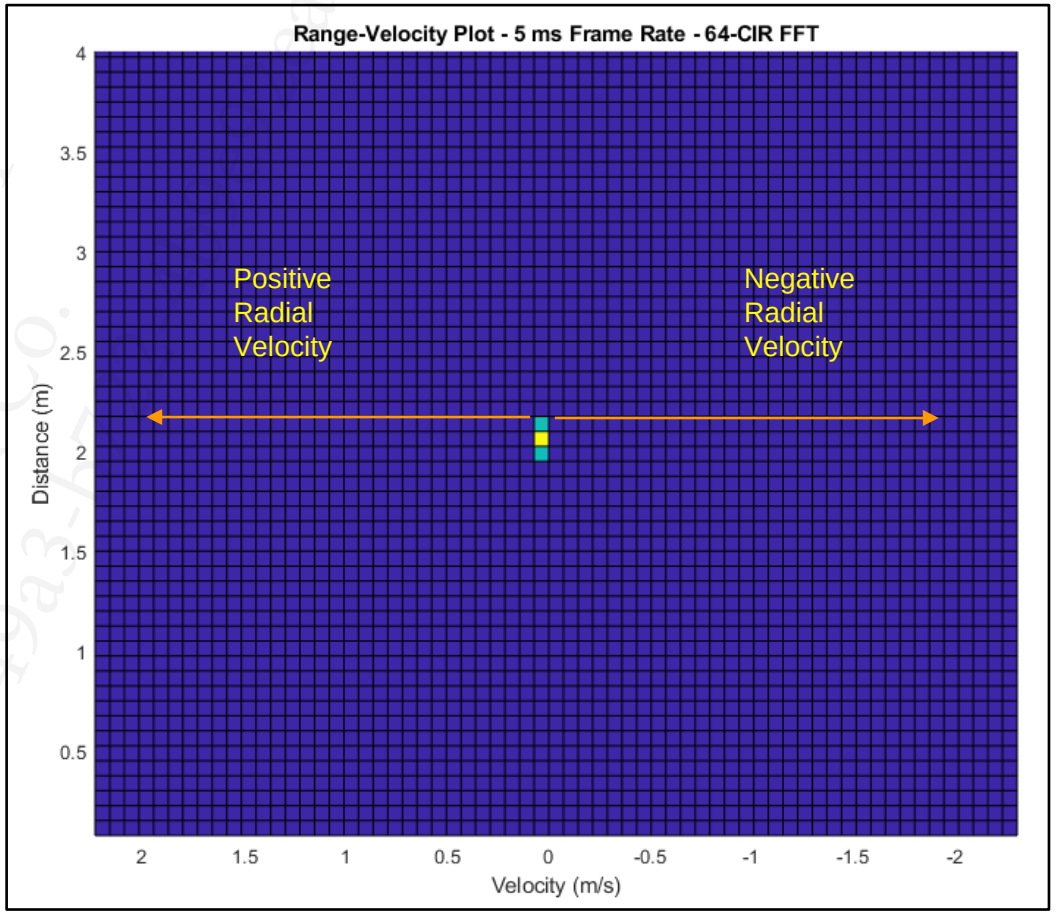


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VELOCITY - 1

- The Velocity can be resolved by applying an FFT across a stack of Channel Impulse Responses
- Maximum Velocity is related to the Frame Repetition Rate:
- $V_{max} = \frac{\lambda}{4*FRR}$
- Velocity Resolution is related to the total observation time:
- $V_{res} = \frac{\lambda}{2*T_f}$





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VELOCITY - 2

- Total observation time:

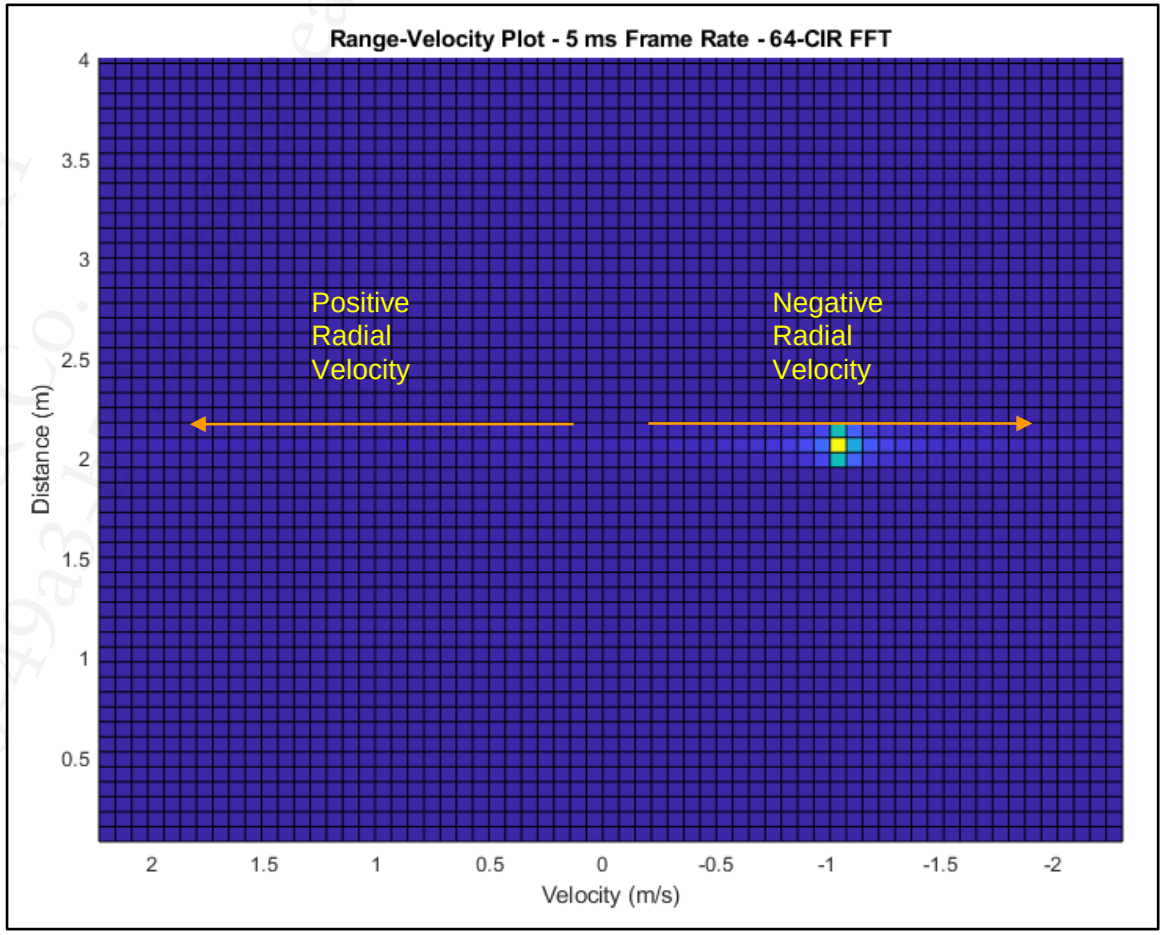
  $T_f = 5\ ms * 64 = 0.32\ s$

  Results in:

  $V_{max} = 2.3\ m/s$

  $V_{res} = 0.072\ m/s$

- Short observation time suitable for rapidly moving targets



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VELOCITY -3

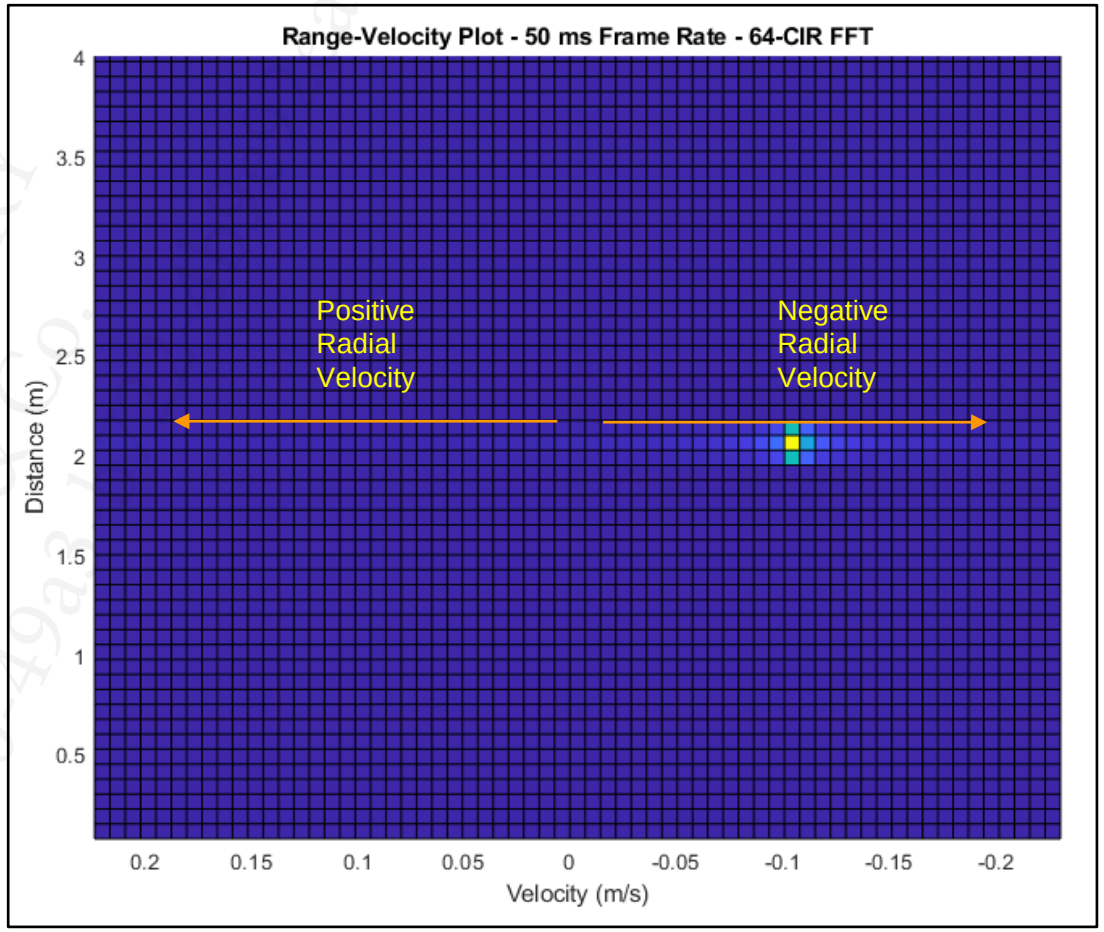
- Total observation time:

$T_f = 50\ ms * 64 = 3.2\ s$

Results in:

$V_{max} = 0.23\ m/s$

$V_{res} = 0.0072\ m/s$



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VELOCITY - 4

- Total observation time:

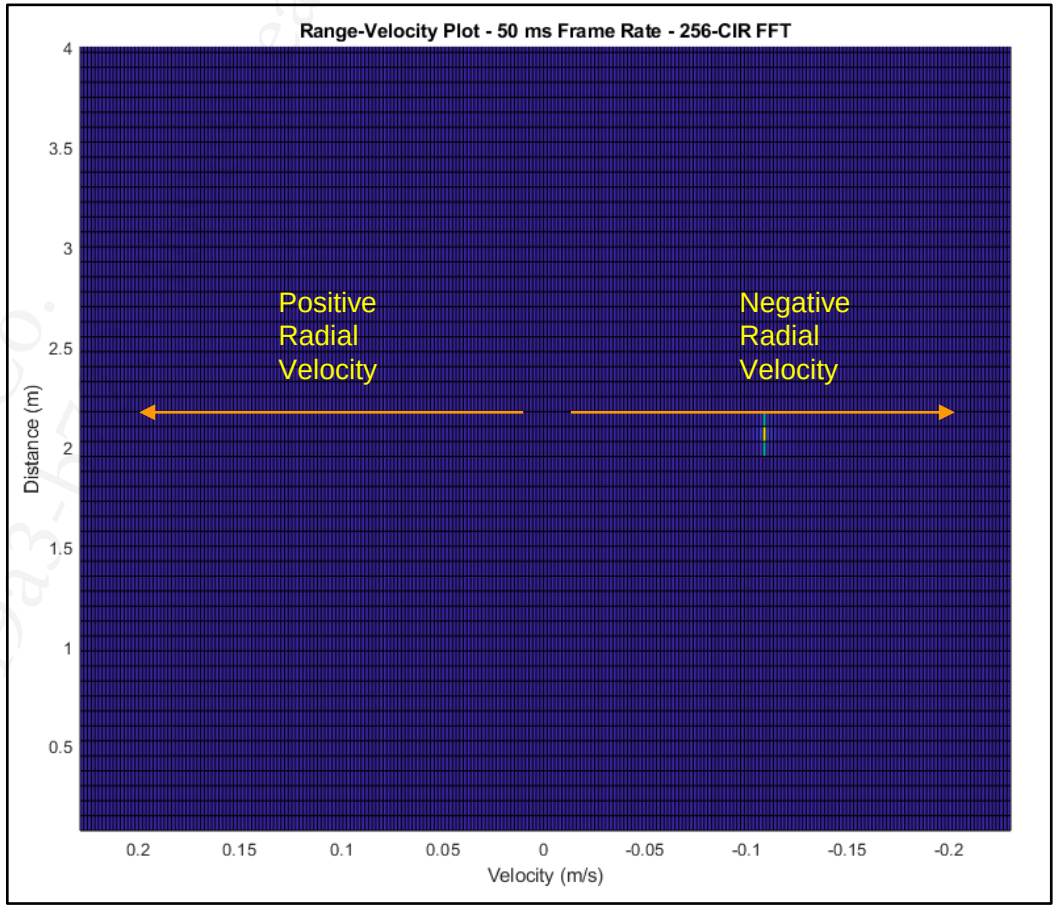
  $T_f = 50\ ms * 256 = 12.8\ s$

  Results in:

  $V_{max} = 0.23\ m/s$

  $V_{res} = 0.0018\ m/s$

- Long observation time for precise detection of slow-moving/changing targets



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ANGLE OF ARRIVAL

- Increased path distance is translated as a phase shift in the Channel Impulse Response data
- The Phase Difference of Arrival (PDoA) can be calculated by subtracting the phases from each paths' CIR at a given distance
- The AoA can hence be calculated as:

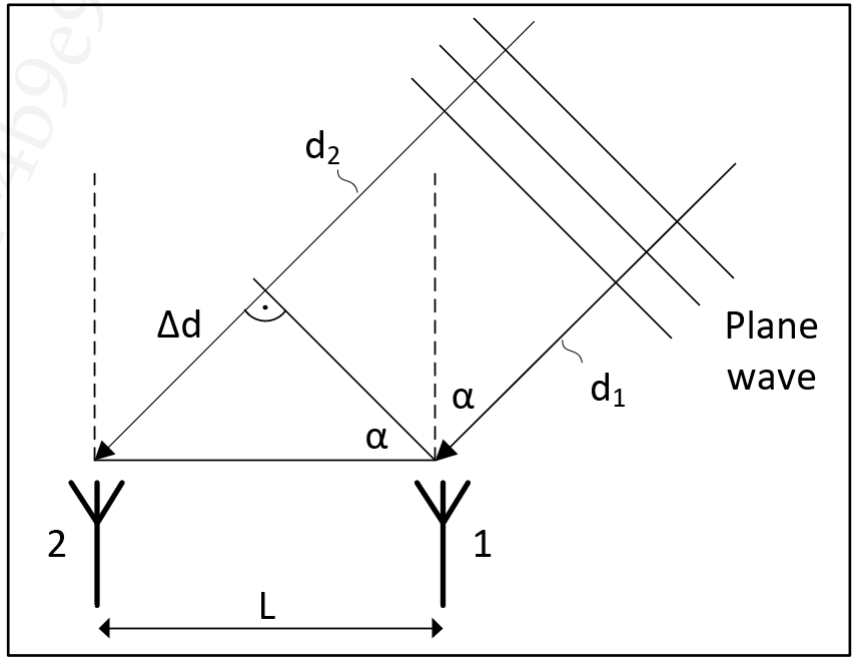
$$\alpha = \arcsin\left(\frac{\lambda\Delta\phi}{L2\pi}\right)$$

- With $L = \frac{\lambda}{2}$, the equation is reduced to:

$$\alpha = \arcsin\left(\frac{\Delta\phi}{\pi}\right)$$

- Example:

For target inducing a phase shift of 30º degrees, the AoA is about ~ 10º degrees from boresight.



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Q&A

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